TidyTuesday Week 44

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Thursday 29th October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we throw two unrelated economic series into a blender and solemnly report whatever comes out. As always, let me get the fine print out of the way before anyone frames a plot and sends it to their financial advisor: these pairs are chosen at random, nobody is claiming anyone causes anyone, and the house specialty here is the spurious correlation. If you came for rigor, you have taken a wrong turn. If you came to watch a Danish green-energy index get regressed against a discontinued Polish recession dummy, pull up a chair.

Monday did exactly that, pairing the OMX Copenhagen Alternative Energy Price Index with a Polish recession indicator that has been dead since 2022. The raw regression found a "significant" relationship, which sounds thrilling until you notice the R-squared was a crushing 0.06, meaning we explained roughly six percent of anything. The real plot twist: the detrended version actually got slightly stronger (a whole 0.07! call the Nobel committee). So technically this one survives detrending, which in this project counts as the rarest of beasts, except the effect is so microscopic it is less a "genuine link" and more two series politely nodding at each other across a crowded room. Tuesday, mercifully, delivered the week's one honest result: car-part export prices versus Chilean purchases of U.S. agency bonds produced absolutely nothing, raw or detrended, p-values a proud 0.43 and 0.90. Nothing. Nada. A pair so uncorrelated it restores my faith in the universe.

Then came Wednesday, the drama queen of the week. Consumer motor vehicle leases owned by finance companies versus foreign-held mortgage-backed securities posted a jaw-dropping raw R-squared of 0.81. Eighty-one percent! I nearly stood up and applauded. And then, as is tradition, the detrending guillotine came down – and while the relationship did survive (R-squared 0.44, still significant), it got cut nearly in half, which is the statistical equivalent of a souffle deflating the moment you open the oven. A big chunk of that glorious 0.81 was just two financial series drifting through the decades together, as financial series do. Still, holding onto 0.44 after detrending is genuinely more interesting than most weeks manage, so I will grudgingly tip my hat.

Thursday rounded things out with Covered Employment versus a Midwest house price index, and this is the trend-mirage this whole project was built to mock: a magnificent raw R-squared of 0.79 that collapses to 0.17 once you strip out the shared "everything goes up over time" drift. Employment rises, house prices rise, and a linear regression breathlessly concludes they are soulmates. They are not. They just both happened to grow for fifty years, like most things denominated in dollars or people. So to recap: one pair of true strangers, two trend-fueled romances that cooled considerably under scrutiny, and one tiny Danish-Polish flirtation that technically held up while meaning essentially nothing. Another week, another reminder that correlation, causation,

and coincidence are three very different things, and this newsletter proudly traffics in only the third.

2 Date: 2026-10-26

Series ID: NASDAQCX601020PI
This series is titled OMX Copenhagen Alternative Energy Price Index and has a frequency of Daily. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2008-12-30 and the observation end date is 2026-10-23.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: POLRECDM
This series is titled OECD based Recession Indicators for Poland from the Peak through the Trough (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are +1 or 0 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1995-02-01 and the observation end date is 2022-08-31.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_POLRECDM	**R-squared:**	0.057
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.057
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	206.4
Date:	Mon, 26 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	1.74e-45
Time:	17:43:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-2167.1
No. Observations:	3419	**AIC:**	4338.
Df Residuals:	3417	**BIC:**	4351.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	0.4795	0.013	36.620	0.000	0.454	0.505
value_fred_NASDAQCX601020PI	-4.034e-05	2.81e-06	-14.366	0.000	-4.58e-05	-3.48e-05

Omnibus:	47995.954	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.009
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	514.195
Skew:	0.676	**Prob(JB):**	2.21e-112
Kurtosis:	1.665	**Cond. No.**	7.83e+03

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 7.83e+03. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

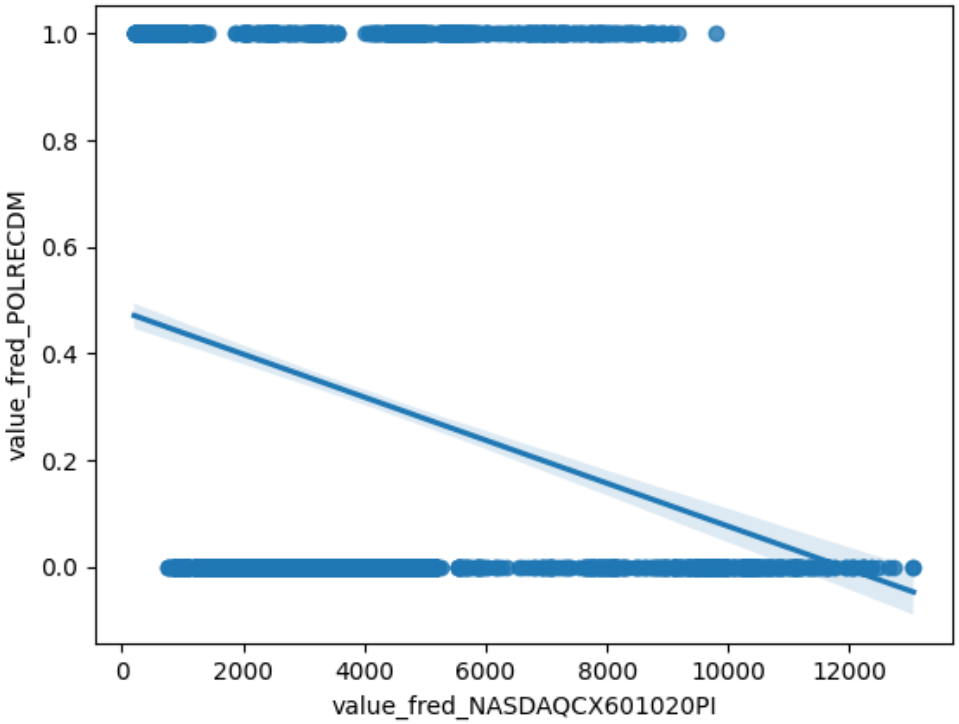


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-26

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_POLRECDM_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.071
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.071
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	262.7
Date:	Mon, 26 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	5.73e-57
Time:	17:43:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-2123.7
No. Observations:	3419	**AIC:**	4251.
Df Residuals:	3417	**BIC:**	4264.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-2.884e-14	0.008	-3.74e-12	1.000	-0.015	0.015
value_fred_NASDAQCX601020PI_detrended	-7.539e-05	4.65e-06	-16.207	0.000	-8.45e-05	-6.63e-0

Omnibus:	113787.732	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.009
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	482.553
Skew:	0.631	**Prob(JB):**	1.64e-105
Kurtosis:	1.660	**Cond. No.**	1.66e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.66e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

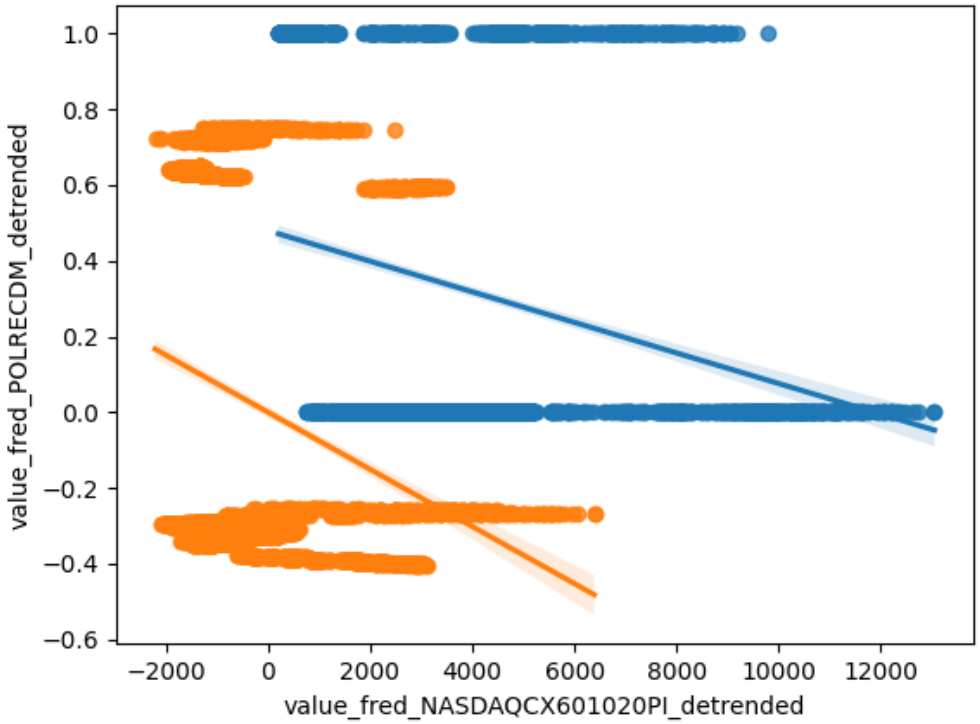


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-26

3 Date: 2026-10-27

Series ID: IY33632

This series is titled Export Price Index (NAICS): Motor Vehicle Electrical and Electronic Equipment Manufacturing and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 2008=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2008-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: FORLTAGCYNET30406

This series is titled Foreign Net Transactions of U.S. Long-Term Agency Bonds: Chile and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1985-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FORLTAGCYNET30406	**R-squared:**	0.003
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.002
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.6151
Date:	Tue, 27 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.434
Time:	20:06:38	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1228.3
No. Observations:	212	**AIC:**	2461.
Df Residuals:	210	**BIC:**	2467.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	76.4398	92.089	0.830	0.407	-105.098	257.978
value_fred_IY33632	-0.7484	0.954	-0.784	0.434	-2.630	1.133

Omnibus:	296.720	**Durbin-Watson:**	2.046
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	32875.754
Skew:	6.102	**Prob(JB):**	0.00
Kurtosis:	62.773	**Cond. No.**	1.62e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.62e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

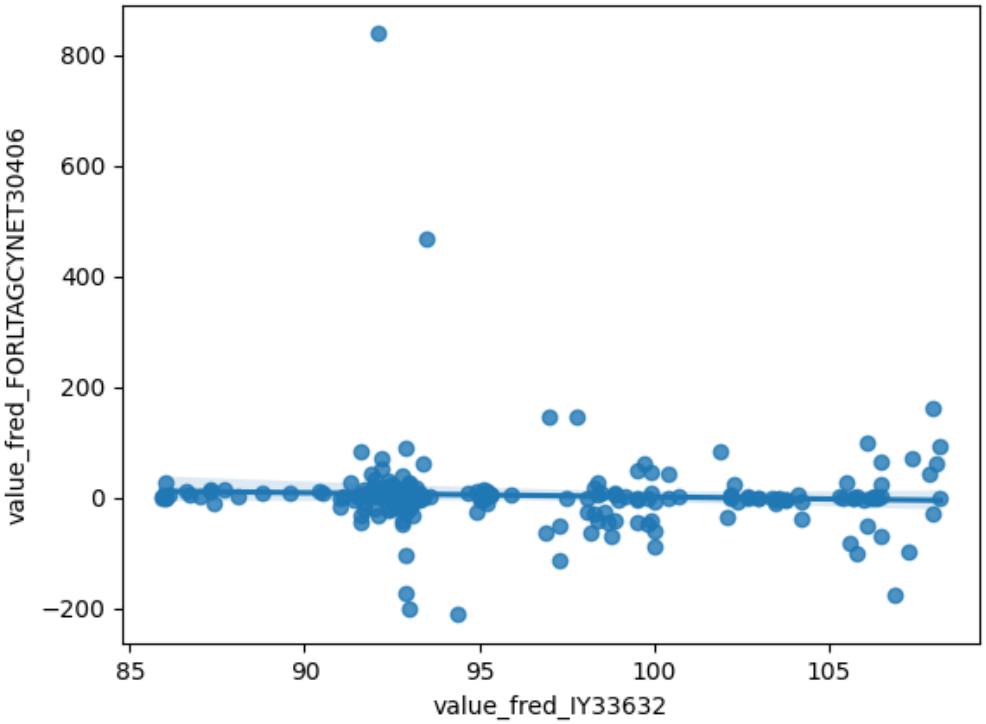


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-27

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FORLTAGCYNET30406_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.005
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.01566
Date:	Tue, 27 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.901
Time:	20:06:39	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1228.1
No. Observations:	212	**AIC:**	2460.
Df Residuals:	210	**BIC:**	2467.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.565e-12	5.476	2.86e-13	1.000	-10.794	10.794
value_fred_IY33632_detrended	-0.1687	1.348	-0.125	0.901	-2.825	2.488

Omnibus:	295.354	**Durbin-Watson:**	2.049
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	32265.413
Skew:	6.055	**Prob(JB):**	0.00
Kurtosis:	62.212	**Cond. No.**	4.06

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

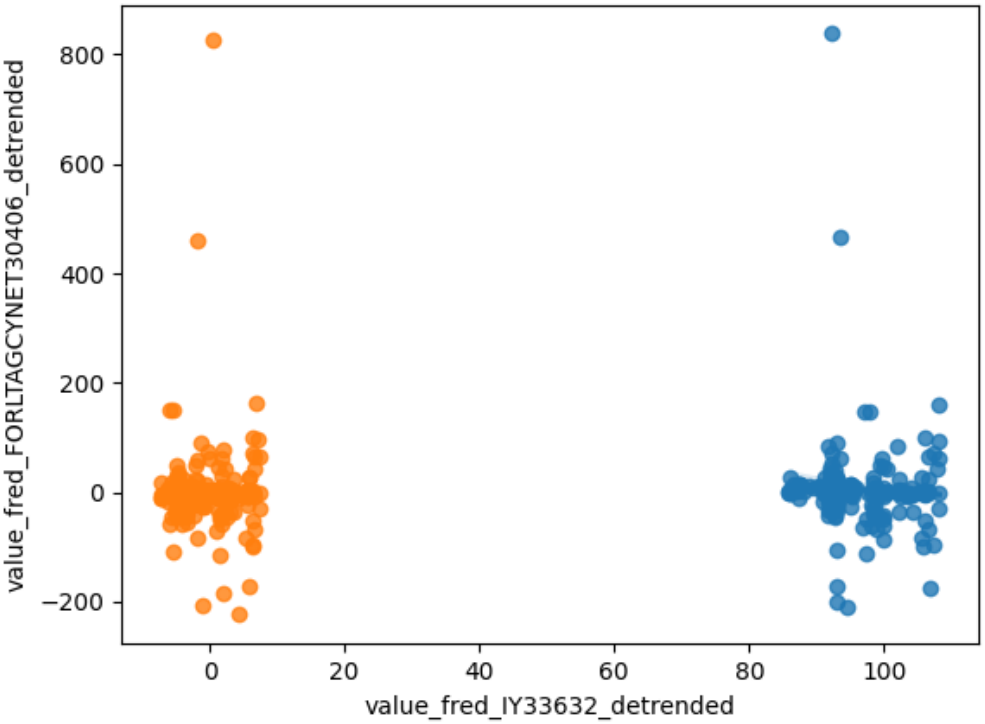


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-27

4 Date: 2026-10-28

Series ID: DTCORVHFNM
This series is titled Consumer Motor Vehicle Leases Owned by Finance Companies, Level and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1980-06-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01.The popularity of this series is 13.

Series ID: OMBFRIM027SBOG
This series is titled Other Securities: Mortgage-Backed Securities, Foreign-Related Institutions and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Billions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2009-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_OMBFRIM027SBOG	**R-squared:**	0.811
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.810
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	872.2
Date:	Wed, 28 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	2.03e-75
Time:	17:29:33	**Log-Likelihood:**	-373.28
No. Observations:	205	**AIC:**	750.6
Df Residuals:	203	**BIC:**	757.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	17.1997	0.459	37.497	0.000	16.295	18.104
value_fred_DTCORVHFNM	-7.456e-05	2.52e-06	-29.533	0.000	-7.95e-05	-6.96e-05

Omnibus:	20.349	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.152
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	23.791
Skew:	0.816	**Prob(JB):**	6.82e-06
Kurtosis:	2.650	**Cond. No.**	7.94e+05

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 7.94e+05. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

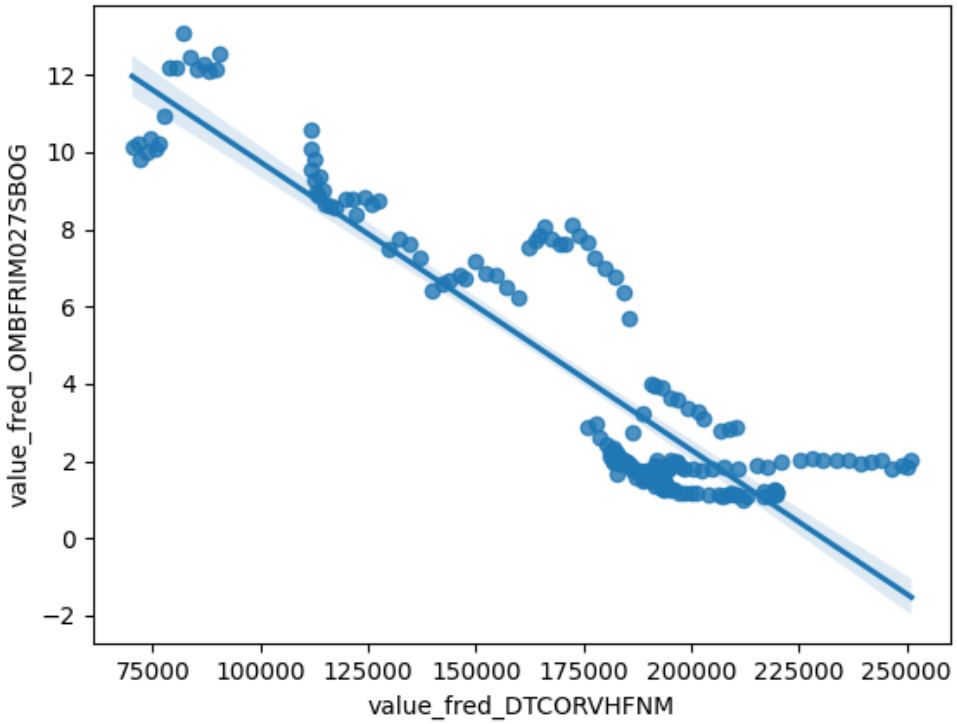


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-28

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_OMBFRIM027SBOG_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.445
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.442
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	162.8
Date:	Wed, 28 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	9.21e-28
Time:	17:29:33	**Log-Likelihood:**	-348.91
No. Observations:	205	**AIC:**	701.8
Df Residuals:	203	**BIC:**	708.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.902e-12	0.093	-2.04e-11	1.000	-0.184	0.184
value_fred_DTCORVHFNM_detrended	-5.049e-05	3.96e-06	-12.759	0.000	-5.83e-05	-4.27e-05

Omnibus:	22.829	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.125
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	8.351
Skew:	0.217	**Prob(JB):**	0.0154
Kurtosis:	2.112	**Cond. No.**	2.35e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.35e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

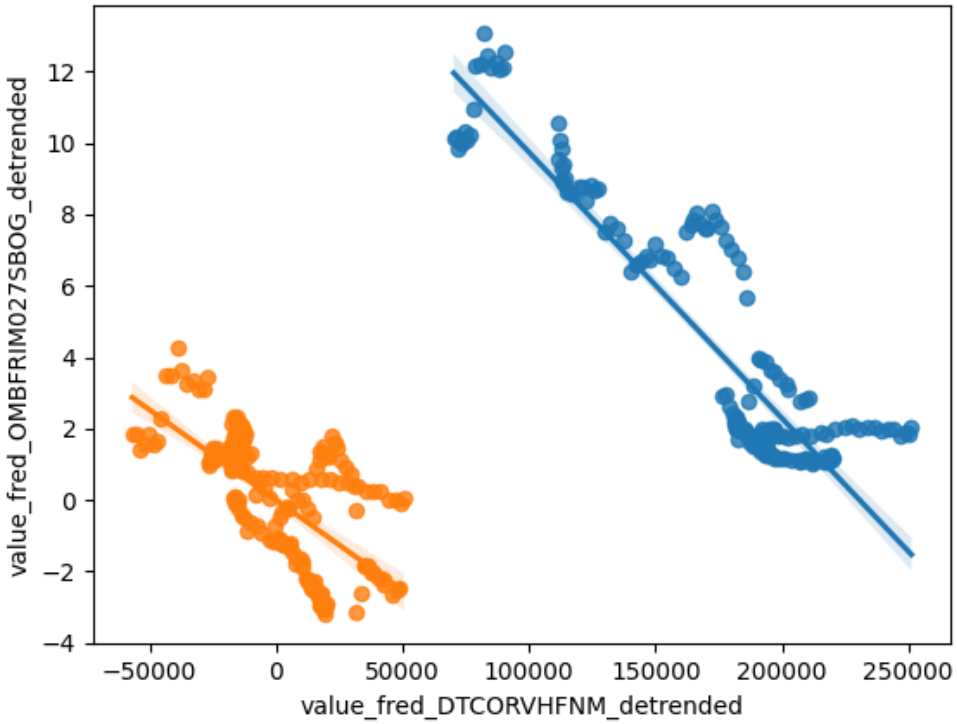


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-28

5 Date: 2026-10-29

Series ID: COVEMP
This series is titled Covered Employment and has a frequency of Weekly, Ending Saturday. The units are Number and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1971-01-02 and the observation end date is 2026-10-10.The popularity of this series is 16.

Series ID: PONHPI00106M226N
This series is titled Purchase Only House Price Index for the East North Central Census Division and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 1991=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1991-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PONHPI00106M226N	**R-squared:**	0.787
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.784
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	218.3
Date:	Thu, 29 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	1.72e-21
Time:	17:40:13	**Log-Likelihood:**	-300.50
No. Observations:	61	**AIC:**	605.0
Df Residuals:	59	**BIC:**	609.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-444.7300	43.423	-10.242	0.000	-531.619	-357.841
value_fred_COVEMP	4.924e-06	3.33e-07	14.776	0.000	4.26e-06	5.59e-06

Omnibus:	6.707	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.108
Prob(Omnibus):	0.035	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	4.815
Skew:	0.551	**Prob(JB):**	0.0900
Kurtosis:	2.174	**Cond. No.**	1.30e+09

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.3e+09. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

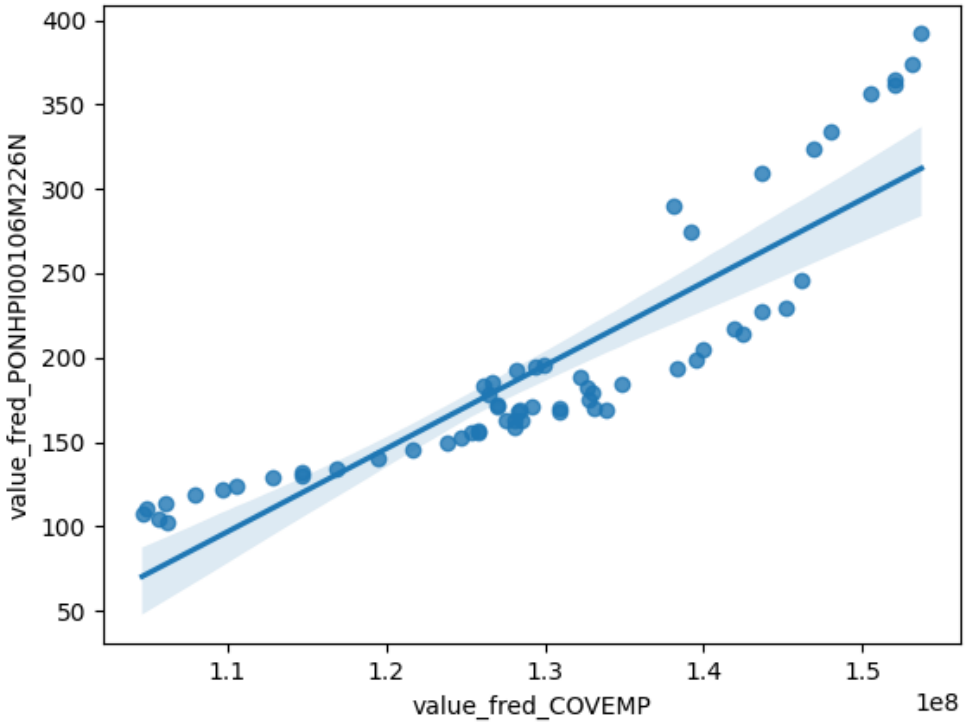


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-29

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PONHPI00106M226N_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.170
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.156
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	12.07
Date:	Thu, 29 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.000965
Time:	17:40:13	**Log-Likelihood:**	-299.68
No. Observations:	61	**AIC:**	603.4
Df Residuals:	59	**BIC:**	607.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	4.801e-12	4.285	1.12e-12	1.000	-8.574	8.574
value_fred_COVEMP_detrended	3.658e-06	1.05e-06	3.475	0.001	1.55e-06	5.76e-06

Omnibus:	4.556	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.081
Prob(Omnibus):	0.103	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	3.381
Skew:	0.437	**Prob(JB):**	0.184
Kurtosis:	2.248	**Cond. No.**	4.07e+06

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.07e+06. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

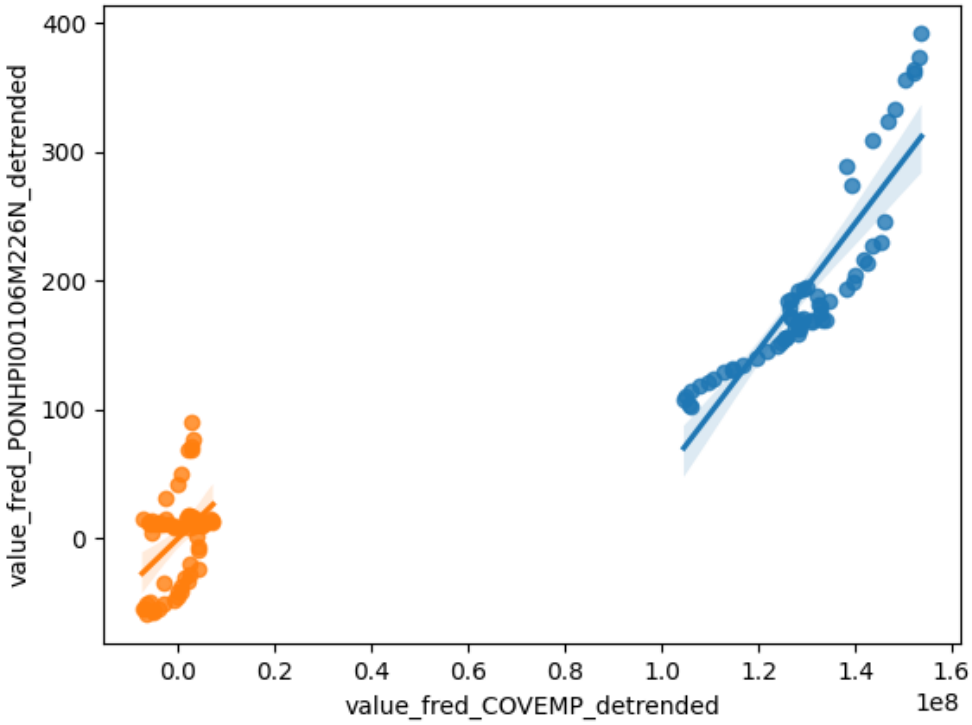


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-29